



VertiGO!!!

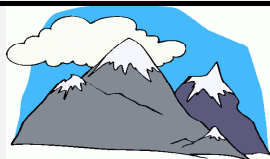


Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Section Night 2 March 2009

Short Talks: We have a line up of 3 great talks. 1) Mt Manakau in the Kaikoura's – an epic adventure of wind, rivers, rain, snow and 2 very broken tents. 2) The West Buttress of Stargazer – a near vertical 600m shist pinnacle on the flanks of Mt Aspiring. 3) 3 Icy Peaks – Elie De Beaumont, Hochstetter Dome & Green.



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



Payne's Ford Trip Report - 22-25 Jan09

This was a somewhat spontaneous gathering of Wellington climbers at the Payne's Ford crag near Takaka past Nelson. Over 3 days around 13-14 climbers succumbed to the joys of climbing on limestone at Payne's Ford and Pohara. That is when they weren't swimming in the sea or in the refreshing swimming holes at the Ford! Which was only to be expected in the windless 30 degree heat that prevailed throughout.

For the advanced climbers (i.e. grades 20-25) there were plenty of opportunities at Payne's to extend themselves. For the mid-Range climbers, after they had exhausted the dozen or so mid-range climbs at Paynes which were nearly all on the first crag, they rapidly retreated to the much more extensive and well bolted Pohara crags adjacent to the beach. Here there were 3 times as many climbs in the 15-19 range and all much longer (up to 25m). Early starts were advisable as from around 10-11am the shade was very sketchy.

Each day was finished off with good pub meals either at Pohara (Guinness and Cricket on Sky) or at the Mussel Inn. Marvelous!



Whanganui Bay Trip Report - 5-7Dec08

This was the biggest club trip of the year with 15 participants spending 2 primo days at "The Bay". Our first day at the Bay got off to a sobering start with the group spending the first hour or two trying to help in the helicoptering out of an injured climber. If nothing else it was good to know that when things go wrong the local ambulance and rescue helicopter crews will be there in a flash to sort you out. Best of luck in your recovery, Troy. Most of the focus was on the two

extensive crags on the TR of The Bay = Whekenui and The Plateau.

Steve Minchin - My two days of climbing was characterised by a tendency to bite off more than I could chew – in fact, I think I successfully failed to make it clean up any climb I attempted. Saturday saw Forever Tuesday Morning, Piki Mai, and Rabbits in Disguise all foiling my plans of global domination while successfully removing great chunks of skin from my fingers. Great friction and lovely pockets are not the best when one has the hands of an office worker! It also turns out that sliding down a slab on ones fingertips is not the best way to bail from a climb... Paul and Jason both put in fine shows on these climbs, saving my bacon and retrieving the gear left behind when I bailed mid pitch :)

On Sunday I made a hearty attempt to climb Wedgewood on trad and promptly turned into a whimpering fool, and it was only as a result of Iain's encouragement and advice that I was able to avoid certain death. ShiChang then followed with a valiant assent that made me wonder what I'd been so worried about. The remainder of the morning was spent working on ShiChang's Jeans and Small Pocks, with a good number of us including Catherine and Kate all taking turns to grunt and sweat our way up the face. Great fun, all round.

Kevin Patterson - I learnt some excellent trad placements following Iain Johnson up James Stirling Direct (17). Then came into my own leading and placing gear on the second pitch of Tibia (16) which was quite exposed. This is a really nice climb with two of the three pitches between walls about 1-1.5m apart - nice bridging moves, not too hard on the arms. Although a bit run-out (8m) on the first pitch (i.e. no protection if you get the lingo!). Huge 50m rap at the end.

Day 2 was even better climbing a 19 (Ego Trip) plus a few others. Ended the weekend sifting with a few beers on the beach when it got too hot to do anything else. Truly I have been turned to the dark side.



Wellington Section members are truly nuts... here is the proof!

Section members Richard Davies and Kieran Paton and ex-section member Ben Clark decided to express their love on Valentines day. Their love of ridiculous challenges that is....

Leaving a chilly Putara roadend (Northern Tararuas) just after 4am on the morning of Valentines day we raced up on to the tops above Herepai Hut in the dark and at dawn began running south down the main range of the Tararuas, the endless tussock bumps passed in a blur, with a cold breeze keeping conditions bearable the first sit down was at Junction Knob after about 10hrs. Maungahuka Hut was reached in 14 and a half hours. Passing through Kime Hut under a large yellow moon in 18hrs meant that the scarcely believable sub 24hr PK (Putara-Kaitoke) was on. Sadly the moonlit southern crossing and Marchant ridge broke us and we stumbled out to Kaitoke 26hr 52mins after leaving Putara carpark, just after our second dawn of the trip. Still a fun day out, just snuck in as my longest day out in the hills and the 4th fastest PK I am aware of. Recommended. Maybe.

Richard Davies



CLASSIFIED



SEEKING THE WHEREABOUTS OF...

I am trying to track down the very few surviving members of the dog-sledging expedition in the central Transantarctic Mountains 1960/61.

One person in particular Club members may be able to assist in finding the whereabouts of, is **Neville Cooper**. At the time he was an engineering student and NZ Alpine Club member.

He also participated in the first NZ Alpine Club expedition to northern Victoria Land in Antarctica in the preceding summer of 1959/60.

Any information gratefully received. Please contact Malcolm Laird malcolm.laird@canterbury.ac.nz home 03 355 6581, or work 03 364 2770



CLUB NOTICES



New Treasurer Needed

We are looking for a new Treasurer for the Wellington Section as our current one is about to embark on a new adventure. Can anyone who is interested please contact Karen Domaneschi on 475 8453. Start early March.



New Committee Members Needed

Do you want to give something back to the Wellington Section? Looking for a way to become more involved? Then here is the perfect opportunity!

The committee meets once a month to discuss, plan and drive the Wellington sections activities and courses. From Rock Hop to Banff to AIC, you can share your ideas, develop initiatives, organize events and have heaps of FUN!! You will meet new people, form strong relationships with other passionate people, and the best thing is – YOU GET TO TALK ABOUT CLIMBING...LOTS!!!

You don't need to be a 'hardcore' climber, or have even been a member for years and years. You just need to love climbing, want to give something back and have one evening a month to meet with other committee members. All tasks and jobs are shared amongst the group.

For more information please contact Louise Thornley on louise.thornley@gmail.com



406 MHz Distress Beacons

The NZAC has received a fact sheet on the new 406 MHz distress beacons.

It can be read on our website Beacons page under the INFO header, here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/342> - Scroll down to "EPIRB Personal Locator Beacons" for the Distress Beacons Upgrade Information PDF



Pumori Expedition 2009

This expedition will have the support of two NZMGA guides, (Tim O'Leary - Alpine Heliski and Woody - HIMEX) who will oversee some aspects of the climb such as rope fixing in the lower, ice-cliff prone section of the climb. However, this is a private expedition, not a guided climb, and climbers will be acting independently on the mountain. Interested climbers will therefore need to have the competence to be self-sufficient on the terrain Pumori presents.

Details and approximate costings are as follows:

Dates are ex Kathmandu 1st of October allow 30 days

US \$ 10-12,000 per person

The above cost includes:

- 1 2x NZMG certified mountain guides
- 2 Equipment allowance, daily allowance & insurance for base camp staff (Sirdar, cook, kitchen boy and liaison officer)
- 3 Flights to transfer climbing members, staff, liaison officer and cargo of the climbing gear.
- 4 Food and fuel at the base camp
- 5 High altitude food and fuel
- 6 All camping equipment at the base camp such as, member tent, dining tent, kitchen tent, chairs, tables and high tents.
- 7 Ropes, snow bars, ice screws etc.
- 8 2 x Climbing Sherpa support
- 9 Trek support for climbing members from Lukla-base camp-Lukla.
- 10 Porters to carry loads from Lukla-base camp-Lukla
- 11 Royalty/ peak permit fee

The above cost does not include:

- 1 Personal accident insurance and emergency rescue operation.
- 2 Visa fee
- 3 Flight fare to and from Kathmandu.
- 4 Accommodation in Kathmandu before and after the expedition
- 5 Other expenses of personal nature

Please contact : Andrew Evans on are1976@yahoo.com.au or ph 021 100 3423



NZAC Awards and Trophies

The National Office has attempted, over the years, to find out whatever happened to, and in some cases what are, some of our trophies.

One of the Photocomp awards, the “Harrison Memorial Trophy” turned up recently as a painting that is hanging in Unwin Lodge, after being missing for many years. In consequence we are again trying to find out more about the various awards and so a webpage has been created to give us a starting point. If members would please have a look at the website - Activities and Insurance header drop down menu under Awards and Trophies <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/385> and see if they are able to fill in any of the blanks in our information. Most winners will likely be found in past Climbers and Journals, but I haven't yet had time to dig them out, so if anyone has a spare moment to do this, it would be greatly appreciated.

Contact: margaret@alpineclub.org.nz if you are able to assist, thanks.

Obituary. Andrew Lynch. 1958- 2009

Andrew Lynch was a family man, farmer, trumper, mountaineer, and many more things. Most of all, Andrew was a great friend to do trips with, to share notes, and to share enjoyment of the Outdoors and help others there. He was a tough bush and mountain man, with no pack too heavy or hill too big to climb. Farming near the Tararua foothills naturally gave Andrew plenty of opportunities for North Island tramping trips, then to the Southern Alps, Himalayas, and many other areas. His not inconsiderable knowledge and experience was freely given to school groups, tramping club snowcraft instruction courses, and the like. His face was frequently captured on camera in the mountain environment, then printed in magazines and guide books. That face won't be forgotten. Andrew won't be forgotten. Goodbye friend.

By Tony Gates





ROCK CLIMBING!!!!

A black and white photograph of a person climbing a large rock. In the background, other people are standing on rocks. The text 'nzag national bouldering series 2009' is overlaid on the image. A circular logo with 'nbs' is in the bottom left corner.

nzag national bouldering series 2009

WAITOMO 14 February
BARING HEAD 21 February
JARDINES 7 March
SPITTLE HILL 14 March

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The National Bouldering Series is really fun, only competitive if you want it to be and you can win great prizes. Start limbering up, bring your friends and have a brilliant day at our best bouldering destinations nationally. Don't forget we supply the sausies and drinks afterwards.

Visit www.nbs.org.nz for instructions on where and how to wear out your fingertips.

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CLUB TRIPS



AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

**6-8Mar09 – Wharepapa South – Level = 12-19 (120 routes) + some 20+ (40 routes)
– Rock – Trip Leader Steve Minchin, contact 021 127 3925**

Outstanding chance to climb on a wide variety of mid-graded ignimbrite (volcanic rock). An exciting mix of bolted and trad routes 55km south of Hamilton. We'll plan to camp in the area leaving Wellington after work on Friday. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



**8-14Apr09 – Easter Weekend – Arrowsmiths from the Lawrence - = AIC Graduate
and 0-3 years experience - Trip Leader TBA**

Chance to use some of those lazy last days of the autumn before the first of the snows come in. Walk in will be from Erewhon. The rock is better on western side of the Arrowsmith range. Friday High Camp, Saturday Summit, Sunday Spare Day, Monday Walk Out, Tuesday drive home. There exists the potential for doing a new rock route so bring your cams! Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Mt Arrowsmith

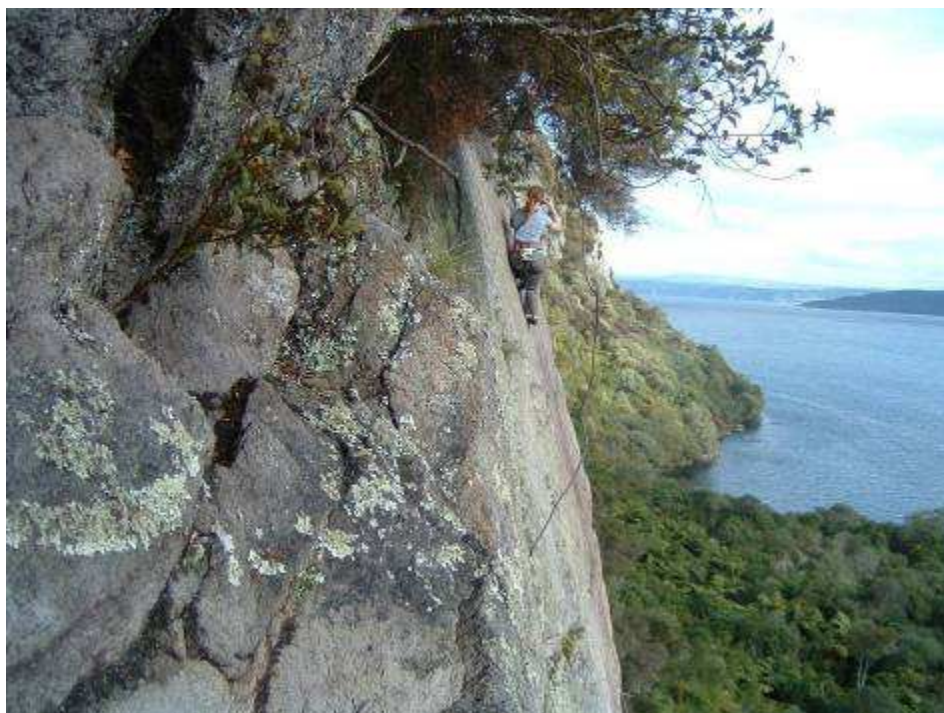
24-26Apr09 – Whanganui Bay – Trip Leader TBA – Level = Grade 16-25+ Rock

Come join us for a weekend of sport and trad climbing at Whanganui Bay. Plan is to leave Wellington after work on Friday evening and tent for 2 nights at the Bay. With over 1000 routes to choose on classic ignimbrite rock adjacent to the beautiful Lake Taupo from this is truly the Mecca of North Island rock climbing. Try yourself out on the Whekenui classics of Small Pocks (19, sport), James Stirling Direct (17, trad), and the 3 pitch chimney climb Tibia (16, trad). Contact Kevin at 027 687 9573 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



8-10May09 – Kawakawa Bay, Taupo – Leader = TBA – Level = Grade 13-22+ Rock

Take a trip to the newly developed crags of nearby Kawakawa Bay. Come along for a weekend of sport (and some trad) climbing on some quality rock, against the backdrop of the largest lake in the North Island. Explore the large number of mid-grade climbs available including the classic 2 pitch High Hopes (16). Hone up on those rock skills with some full pitch climbs. Contact Kevin at 027 687 9573 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Kawakawa Bay

**29May-1Jun09 – Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku (2880m) – QB Weekend – Leader = TBA –
Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience**

Opening alpine snow trip for the winter season! Come climb the second highest peak in NZ outside the Mt Cook area. This was one of Hillary's early climbs back in the 1940's, except instead of doing it in 1 day like Sir Ed did we'll take 3! On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Hodder River to stay at the Hodder Huts – some 66 crossings! On Sunday we'll attempt a summit via the traditional north ridge. No ropes required. Contact Kevin at 027 687 9573 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku Summit ridge

3-5Jul08 - Ruapehu South - Girdlestone and Tahurangi – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Tahurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Tahurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Ruapehu Crater Lake

7-9Aug09 - Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to

the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



North Ruapehu with the NZAC hut, Pinnacles, and Ngaruhoe

18-21Sep09 – AIC Expedition – AIC Grads First Preference, All Welcome – Destination TBA (Northern South Island) - Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience – Contact Point = Don French

The destination is to be set by the AIC group, as part of the planning exercise. It is a 'mystery trip'. Come and join the AIC graduates and welcome them to the world of mountaineering. This could even be a good chance to discover a new climbing buddy! Contact Point = Don French, ph 06 377 7117 (h) or email df@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz





WELLINGTON SECTION: 2008/9 CONTACT LIST

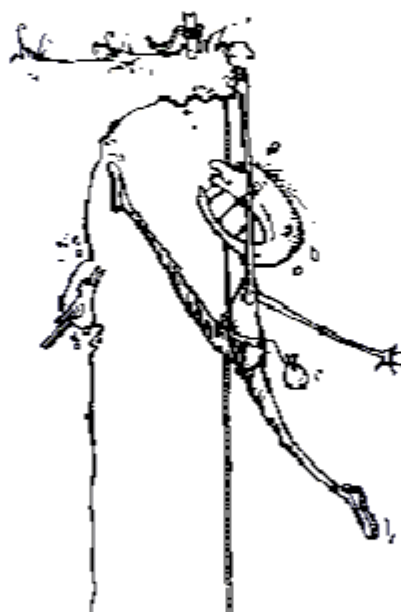
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	Kate Davidson	KD2	N/A
	Kevin Patterson	KP	N/A
	Scott Taylor	ST	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
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Instruction – Summer Rock	Blair Hiscoke	SUMMERROCK or BH	N/A
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* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund or general queries should be directed to the Secretary

Any media queries should be directed to:

National Executive Officer: Ollie Clifton ollie@alpineclub.org.nz (03) 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

